

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer, Detection and Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) and Senior Security Engineer with over five years of experience in detection engineering, threat hunting, incident response and Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) / Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) platform operations. I design, write and maintain detection logic across CrowdStrike NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, building detection capabilities that track attacker techniques across the MITRE ATT&CK framework and are managed as living rules through a structured use-case lifecycle. I respond to security incidents as technical authority, leading investigations aligned to the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) 800-61 Incident Response Lifecycle, and I contribute to Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks that reduce manual toil and accelerate containment. I have built and operated Security Operations Centre (SOC) capabilities at scale across an estate of approximately 8,000 users and am looking to bring those detection engineering and incident response skills to a Cybersecurity Incident Response Team environment where I can collaborate across engineering, threat intelligence and platform teams to measurably improve detection coverage and response effectiveness.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Detection Engineering:** CrowdStrike NG-SIEM and Falcon LogScale, Microsoft Sentinel + Kusto Query Language (KQL), detection rule authoring, tuning and lifecycle management, use-case development from threat intelligence and incident feedback
- **SIEM and EDR Platforms:** CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Incident Response and Threat Hunting:** NIST 800-61 Incident Response Lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK, Cyber Kill Chain, digital forensics, threat hunting, proactive threat identification, incident commander responsibilities
- **Automation and Orchestration:** SOAR playbook development, PowerShell scripting, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), automation of alert triage and containment workflows
- **Vulnerability and Attack Simulation:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; detection gap analysis and coverage reporting
- **Identity and Cloud Security:** Azure Active Directory / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM)
- **Governance Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Lead detection engineering for the UAL Security Operations Centre, regularly writing and maintaining detection logic in Microsoft Sentinel (KQL) and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM to identify suspicious and malicious activity across an estate of approximately 8,000 users.
- Document and track detection capabilities across SIEM and EDR data sources; manage the use-case lifecycle from creation through testing, tuning and retirement, incorporating threat intelligence, analyst feedback and post-incident findings.
- Serve as incident commander during declared cybersecurity incidents, leading containment, investigation and remediation activities aligned to the NIST 800-61 Incident Response Lifecycle and producing post-incident reports with detection improvement recommendations.
- Perform proactive threat hunting exercises using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, Discover and Microsoft Sentinel, mapping findings to MITRE ATT&CK techniques to identify attacker activity not surfaced by

existing detection logic.

- Develop and maintain SOAR automation playbooks in partnership with platform engineering, reducing analyst toil on high-volume alerts and accelerating mean time to respond.
- Collaborate with vulnerability management and red team functions using Pentera BAS and Tenable.io to identify detection gaps and drive continuous improvement in coverage metrics.
- Contribute to detection-related documentation, runbooks and incident response procedures, ensuring all security events are investigated and documented to completion.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Operated CrowdStrike Falcon EDR (Prevent, Insight, Discover) and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint as primary detection and response platforms; triaged EDR and SIEM alerts, investigated incidents and coordinated remediation across the UAL estate.
- Developed KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, creating workbooks, analytic rules and alert suppression logic; reviewed and improved existing detections to reduce false-positive rates and improve signal quality.
- Conducted regular threat hunting sessions aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, identifying indicators of compromise and attacker behaviours not captured by automated detection.
- Responded to and investigated security events in alignment with NIST 800-61, escalating as required, managing stakeholder communications and ensuring all incidents were documented to closure.
- Contributed to SOAR automation development using PowerShell scripting and built response playbooks to automate repetitive alert triage steps.
- Managed BeyondTrust PAM to enforce privileged access governance and reduce the attack surface available to credential-based attackers.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Deployed and managed endpoint protection and security monitoring tools, investigating security alerts and responding to incidents in a SaaS product environment.
- Supported security event log management, configured alerting pipelines and contributed to the development of detection and response procedures.
- Maintained Microsoft Azure Active Directory, Intune and Microsoft 365 security settings, ensuring identity and access policies were consistently enforced across development and production environments.
- Contributed to vulnerability management activities and delivered security awareness training to reduce organisational risk posture.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built end-to-end detection engineering capability at UAL using CrowdStrike NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, delivering a structured use-case library mapped to MITRE ATT&CK that measurably improved detection coverage across cloud and endpoint surfaces.
- Deployed and operationalised CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across an estate of approximately 8,000 users, achieving full endpoint visibility and significantly reducing mean time to detect.
- Led incident response exercises and live incident investigations aligned to NIST 800-61, developing runbooks and playbooks that reduced average containment time.
- Developed SOAR automation playbooks that automated triage of high-volume alert categories, freeing analyst capacity for higher-complexity investigations and threat hunting activities.
- Conducted Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation exercises to identify and close detection gaps, working with platform teams to validate and deploy new detection logic.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)

- CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (United Kingdom)